

One Wrong Move: Puzzle Pool And Pauses Report

Report 005 generated May 2, 2026 in `/Users/kevinhegg/Desktop/one-wrong-move`.

Final Response / Summary

Implemented full pause behavior between rounds, refactored puzzle generation into a reusable pool in `public/puzzles.js`, added same-session replay variation through break signatures, and updated the app so boards are hidden during intro and briefings. The timer now measures active solving time only. Completion includes score, mistakes, share text, Play another mix, and restart.

Files Created Or Changed

- `public/index.html`
- `public/style.css`
- `public/game.js`
- `public/puzzles.js`
- `scripts/validate-puzzles.js`
- `README.md`
- `docs/game-design.md`
- `docs/codex-reports/screenshots/005-*.png`
- `docs/codex-reports/005-puzzle-pool-and-pauses-report.pdf`

Design Rationale

The redesign protects the promise: one board, one rule, one wrong move. Every round starts with a non-spoiler briefing, then reveals a self-contained rule-violation board only after the player starts the active solve. This avoids memory pressure and trivial spot-the-difference scanning.

State Flow

- **intro**: board hidden, timer stopped, daily or variant label shown.
- **briefing**: round name, goal, symbols, and example shown; board hidden; timer stopped.
- **active**: board visible; timer running; wrong taps add mistakes.
- **feedback**: correct answer highlighted; explanation shown; timer stopped.
- **complete**: final score and share controls shown; timer stopped.

Timer Behavior

The timer starts only when **Start Round** reveals a board. It pauses immediately on a correct answer and remains paused during feedback, briefings, transitions, intro, and completion. Wrong taps keep the timer running.

Puzzle-Type Table

Type	Difficulty	Rule System	Break Variations
Rule Rows	Easy	Shifted row recipe	wrong next, duplicate, outside symbol
Conveyor Shift	Easy	Rows shift like a belt	wrong shift, previous-row duplicate, neighbor symbol
Rotation Logic	Medium	Arrows rotate predictably	backward, skipped quarter, opposite
Latin Trap	Medium	One of each symbol per row and column	duplicate, swapped, missing-symbol trap
Pair Pact	Medium	Symbols belong in partner pairs	wrong partner, outsider, unchanged leader
Path Rhythm	Hard	Numbered path alternates movement rhythm	axis repeat, wrong turn, diagonal slip
Mirror Trap	Hard	Right side mirrors with symbol transforms	unchanged, wrong pair, swapped partner

Session Variation Strategy

The first daily play uses the canonical `YYYY-MM-DD` seed. Restart and Play another mix increment `sessionAttempt` in `sessionStorage`. Each generated break signature includes puzzle type id, break mode, answer index, and wrong symbol or movement. Generators avoid previously used signatures for the same type during the browser session; if variants are exhausted, the least recently used signature is allowed as a fallback.

Validation Results

- Repository state verified before edits: `package.json` present, Git repo detected, branch `puzzle-pool-and-pauses`, required public files present, no nested `one-wrong-move/.git` folder.
- `node --check public/puzzles.js`: passed.
- `node --check public/game.js`: passed.
- `node --check scripts/validate-puzzles.js`: passed.
- `node scripts/validate-puzzles.js`: Validated 1200 daily rounds across 100 dates and 7 puzzle types.
- `git diff --check`: passed.
- PASS: App opens directly from `public/index.html`
- PASS: Desktop view is constrained to a phone-sized frame and starts hidden
- PASS: Initial intro does not reveal the puzzle board
- PASS: Timer is paused before Round 1
- PASS: Round 1 briefing pauses timer and hides board
- PASS: Start Round reveals board and starts timer
- PASS: Round 1 has exactly one valid answer
- PASS: Wrong tap increments mistakes
- PASS: Wrong tap keeps timer running

- PASS: Correct tap pauses timer immediately
- PASS: Round 2 briefing hides board
- PASS: Round 2 is active only after Start Round
- PASS: Round 2 has exactly one valid answer
- PASS: Round 3 briefing hides board
- PASS: Round 3 is active only after Start Round
- PASS: Round 3 has exactly one valid answer
- PASS: Game completes after 3 rounds
- PASS: Share text includes score and selected type names
- PASS: Share button is wired (Share result)
- PASS: Play another mix creates Variant 2 intro and hides board
- PASS: Variant 2 active board appears
- PASS: Variant break pattern changes from canonical run
- PASS: Variant label is visible (Variant 2)
- PASS: Fresh headless browser run has no console errors

Local Run Instructions

Open `public/index.html` directly in a browser, or serve the static directory:

```
python3 -m http.server 8080 -d public
```

Then visit `http://localhost:8080`.

Netlify Deploy Settings

- Build command: leave blank
- Publish directory: `public`

Verification Checklist

- App opens directly from `public/index.html`.
- App runs via `python3 -m http.server 8080 -d public`.
- Initial screen hides the puzzle board.
- Timer is paused before Round 1 starts.
- Start Round reveals the board and starts the timer.
- Correct tap pauses the timer and shows explanation.
- Next Round opens a paused briefing with board hidden.
- Rounds 1, 2, and 3 each validate with exactly one answer.
- Wrong taps increment mistakes and keep timer running.
- Completion screen works and share text includes selected puzzle types.
- Play another mix creates Variant 2 with a changed break pattern.
- Fresh headless browser run reports no console errors.

Observed Daily Mix

Canonical run: Rule Rows, Pair Pact, Path Rhythm.

Canonical signatures: rule-rows|wrong-next-symbol|3|● | pair-pact|unchanged-leader|14|● | path-rhythm|repeats-axis|24|9←

Variant 2 signatures: rule-rows|outside-recipe|4|☒ | rotation-logic|skips-quarter-turn|2|✓ | path-rhythm|wrong-turn|2|3↓

Git Commands

```
git status --short
git diff -- public/index.html public/style.css public/game.js public/puzzles.js
scripts/validate-puzzles.js README.md docs/game-design.md
git add public/index.html public/style.css public/game.js public/puzzles.js
scripts/validate-puzzles.js README.md docs/game-design.md docs/codex-
reports/screenshots/005-*.png docs/codex-reports/005-puzzle-pool-and-pauses-report.pdf
git commit -m "Add puzzle pool and paused round flow"
git push origin puzzle-pool-and-pauses
```

Screenshots

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

0.0s

READY

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 0

DAILY PUZZLE READY

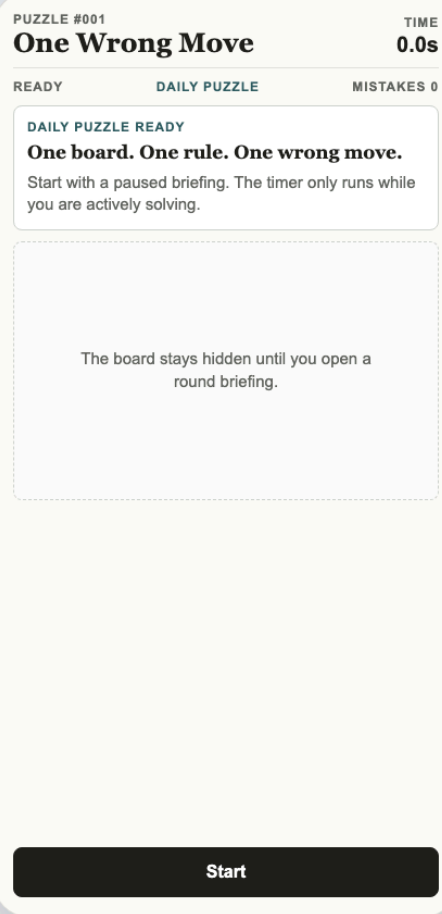
One board. One rule. One wrong move.

Start with a paused briefing. The timer only runs while you are actively solving.

The board stays hidden until you open a round briefing.

Start

Initial intro with hidden board



Desktop/laptop phone-framed start screen

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

0.0s

ROUND 1 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 0

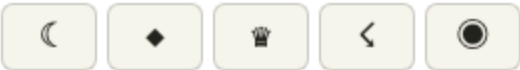
ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row follows a shifted symbol recipe. Find the glyph that breaks its row.

Study the mechanic. The board stays hidden and the timer is paused.

SYMBOLS: ☾ ♦ 👑 ⚡ 🔮 ⚙

EXAMPLE



A clean row recipe: moon, diamond, crown, lightning, eye.

Round 1 is hidden until you press Start Round.

Start Round

Restart

Paused Round 1 briefing

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.3s

ROUND 1 OF 3

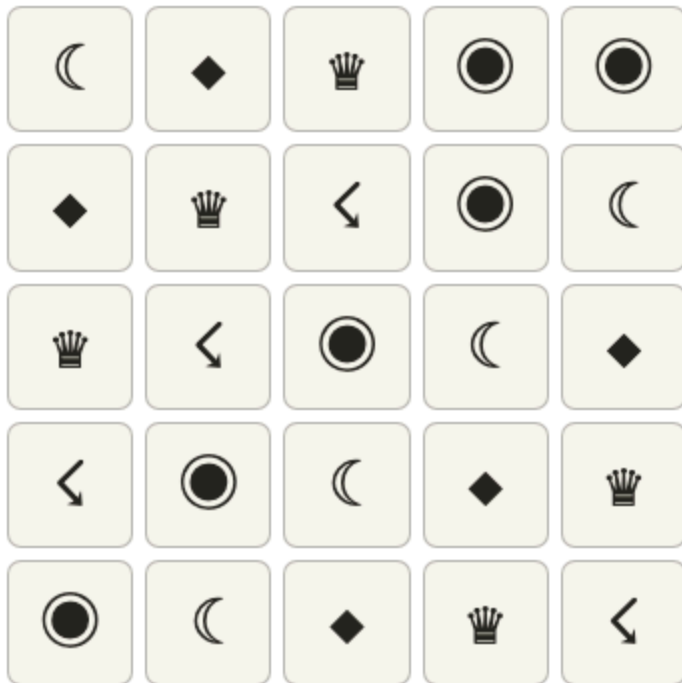
DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 0

ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

**Restart**

Active Round 1 board

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.6s

ROUND 1 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

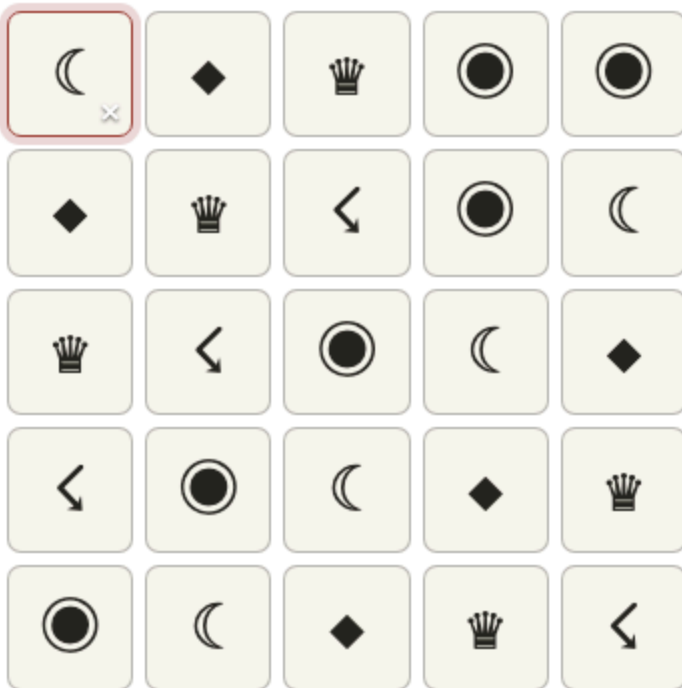
ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

Try again

The row should be a shifted version of the others. Look for the broken recipe, not the rarest symbol.

**Restart**

Wrong-tap feedback while timer continues

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.9s

ROUND 1 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

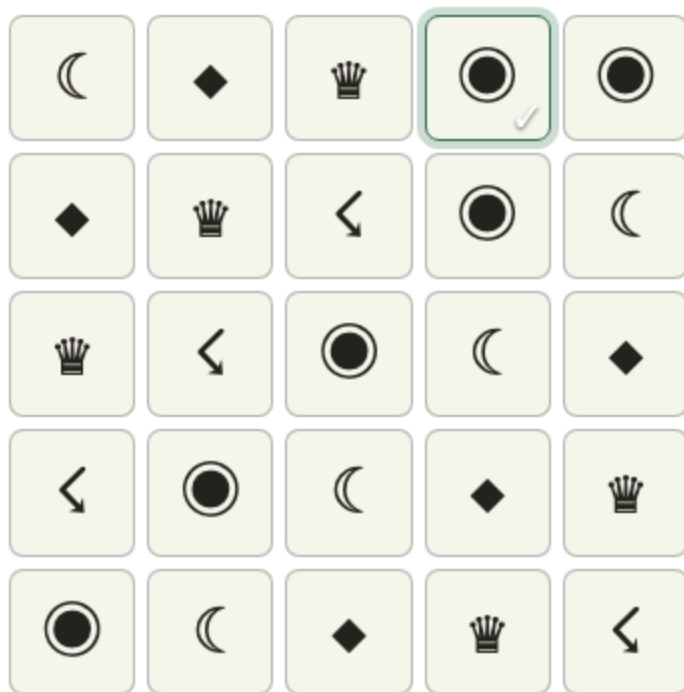
ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

Correct

That glyph breaks the shifted row sequence.

**Next Round****Restart**

Correct feedback with timer paused

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

0.9s

ROUND 2 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

ROUND 2: PAIR PACT

Symbols travel in partner pairs. Find the symbol that breaks a pact.

Study the mechanic. The board stays hidden and the timer is paused.

SYMBOLS: ☾ ☼ ☠ ☵ ⚔ ⚡ ⚙ ⚓ ⚒ ⚔ ⚡ ⚙ ⚓ ⚒

EXAMPLE



Pairs sit together: moon with sun, skull with bone.

Round 2 is hidden until you press Start Round.

Start Round

Restart

Paused Round 2 briefing

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

1.2s

ROUND 2 OF 3

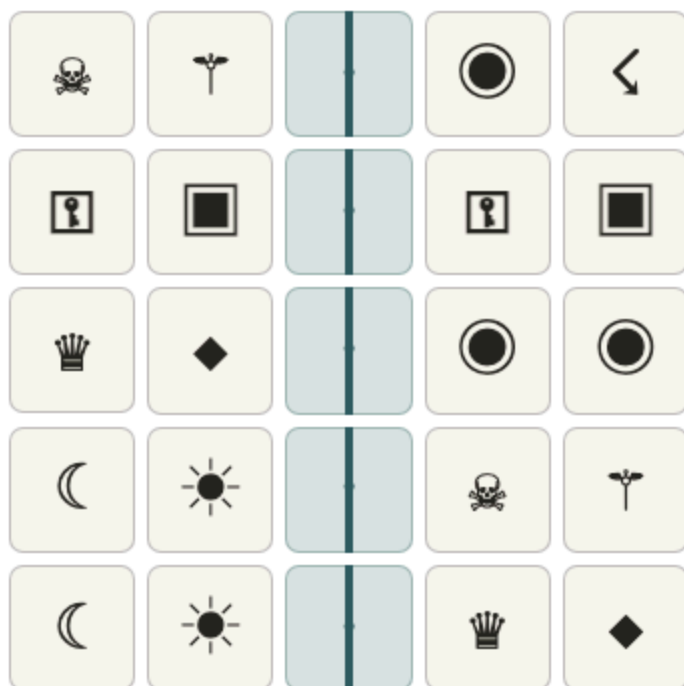
DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

ROUND 2: PAIR PACT

Symbols sit in loyal pairs. One partner has broken the pact.

Infer the recurring pairs, then tap the symbol that is paired with the wrong mate.

**Restart**

Active Round 2 board

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

1.3s

ROUND 3 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

ROUND 3: PATH RHYTHM

A numbered path alternates movement rhythm. Find the first move that breaks the beat.

Study the mechanic. The board stays hidden and the timer is paused.

SYMBOLS: 1→ 2↓ 3→ 4↓ 5→

EXAMPLE

1→

2↓

3→

4↓

5→

The beat alternates horizontal, vertical, horizontal, vertical.

Round 3 is hidden until you press Start Round.

Start Round

Restart

Paused Round 3 briefing

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

1.6s

ROUND 3 OF 3

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

ROUND 3: PATH RHYTHM

Follow the numbered path. The movement rhythm alternates horizontal, vertical, horizontal, vertical.

Find the first numbered move whose arrow breaks the rhythm.

1→	2↓	3→		
		4↓		
		5→	6↓	7→
				8↓
			10↓	9←

Restart

Active Round 3 board

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

1.7s

COMPLETE

DAILY PUZZLE

MISTAKES 1

DAILY PUZZLE SOLVED

Solved 3 of 3

Share your result, play another mix, or restart into a new variant.

SOLVED

3 of 3

TIME

1.7s

MISTAKES

1

SCORE

934

SHARE TEXT

One Wrong Move #001



1.7s

Mistakes: 1

Score: 934

Round 1: Rule Rows

Round 2: Pair Pact

Round 3: Path Rhythm

Share result

Play another mix

Restart

Completion and share screen

PUZZLE #001

One Wrong Move

TIME

0.0s

READY

VARIANT 2

MISTAKES 0

REPLAY VARIANT READY

One board. One rule. One wrong move.

Start with a paused briefing. The timer only runs while you are actively solving.

The board stays hidden until you open a round briefing.

Start Variant

Play another mix: Variant 2 intro

PUZZLE #001

TIME

One Wrong Move

0.3s

ROUND 1 OF 3

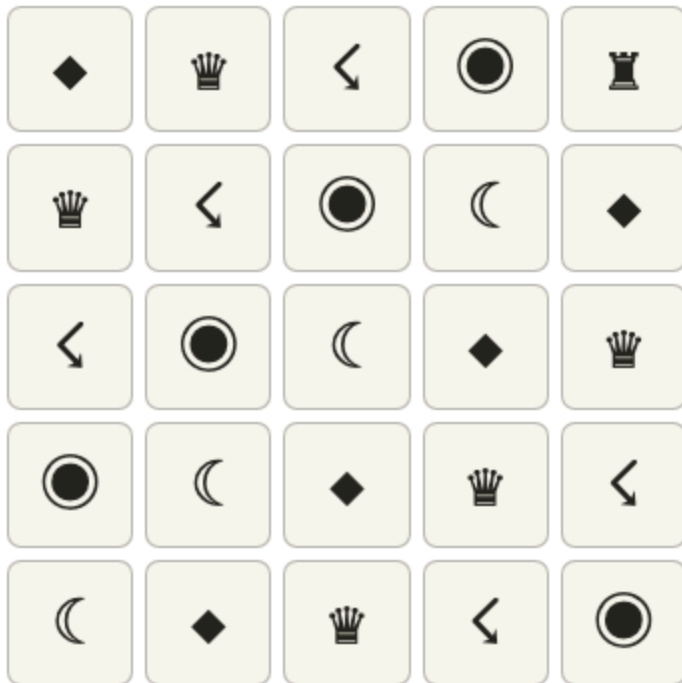
VARIANT 2

MISTAKES 0

ROUND 1: RULE ROWS

Each row uses the same five-symbol recipe, shifted one place. One glyph breaks the row grammar.

Compare rows as sequences, not as pictures. Tap the symbol that does not belong in its row.

**Restart**

Variant 2 active board with changed break pattern